Evidence Map Repair Shop

In this activity, you and a partner will fix four weak evidence map rows, then use what you learned to check your own draft map.

Overview

Weak rows are easy to write and hard to defend. Rows 1 and 2 come from the Therac-25 sample and rows 3 and 4 come from the Tropicana sample, so no one needs computing or design background. Both are class examples, so neither is an allowed topic for your own memo.

Instructions

1. Read the four broken rows below with your partner.
2. For each row, name what is wrong. Use the What to Look For list.
3. Rewrite each row so it is a strong row. Use only the facts on the Source Card with the same number as the row, and use your evidence map handout as a guide.
4. Swap Repair Logs with another pair. Read their repairs and use the What to Look For list to check each row. Tell them one thing that works, then one thing to fix. If nothing needs fixing, ask one question a reader could still have.
5. Open your own draft evidence map. Mark any row with one of the same problems, and fix at least two rows.

The Broken Rows

The table below shows four evidence map rows that each have at least one problem.

#	Claim I will make	Source	Quote / paraphrase	How it supports the claim
1	The Therac-25 was dangerous.	Leveson & Turner (1993)	"Six known accidents involving massive overdoses…several people died and others were seriously injured."	Shows it was dangerous.
2	The FDA made the company recall the machine.	Thompson (1987)	none	What Happened.
3	Tropicana's redesign failed due to mixed reactions and too much change.	Elliott (2009)	Shoppers said they couldn't find it.	Factor 1.

#	Claim I will make	Source	Quote / paraphrase	How it supports the claim
4	Sales dropped a lot after the redesign.	Bloomberg	“In the seven weeks after launch, unit sales fell about 20% and dollar sales fell about 19%, a loss of roughly $33 million.”	Supports the claim.

What to Look For

- A claim that is vague or has no dates or numbers.
- A source you cannot identify, or one with no year.
- A quote or paraphrase that is missing, thin, or not the source's own words.
- A claim that says more than the evidence shows.
- A last column that does not say where the claim goes or what it does there.

Repair Log

Use the table below to record what is wrong with each row and how you fixed it.

Row	What is wrong	Your repair
1	The quote/paraphrase is incorrect.	“Six known accidents involving massive overdoses…several people died and others were seriously injured.”
2	The source is not a news website	Thompson (1987)
3	The Claim is innacurate	Tropicana’s redesign failed due to mixed reactions and too much change.
4	The quote could be more accurate and use quantitive data.	“In the seven weeks after launch, unit sales fell about 20% and dollar sales fell about 19%, a loss of roughly $33 million.”